



英検2級 大問2A 長文空所補充 完全演習

全30セット / 問題編

THINKING 大問別問題集シリーズ | 本番そっくりの形式で30題を演習。

- ・各長文に空所が3つ。文意に沿って **1, 2, 3, 4** から最適なものを選ぶ。
 - ・**コツ**：空所は**選択肢を見る前に**「どんな内容（+/-）が入るか」を前後の論理・接続語から予測 → 選択肢と照合。
 - ・解いたら巻末の解答で答え合わせ → **解説編**で「なぜ正解／なぜ誤りか」と本質的な読み方を確認。
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次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.1 / 地域のモノの貸し出し

A Library of Things

In the town of Hartwell, many households owned tools that they used only once or twice a year. Storing these items took up space, and buying them was expensive. To deal with (1), a group of residents started a service called the Library of Things. Just as a normal library lends books, this service lends items such as drills, tents, and kitchen appliances. Members borrow what they need and return it when they are finished.

The service quickly became popular, and soon hundreds of people had joined. As more members signed up, (2). To solve this, the group built a simple website where members could check what was available and reserve items in advance. This made borrowing easy and helped the volunteers keep track of every item.

The Library of Things has changed how people in Hartwell think about owning things. Instead of buying items they rarely use, residents now share them. (3), the service has reduced waste and brought neighbors closer together. Other towns have noticed its success and have started similar services of their own.

- (1)
- 1 a shortage of skilled workers
 - 2 this waste of space and money
 - 3 the loss of local libraries
 - 4 a lack of public interest

- (2)
- 1 fewer people visited the town library
 - 2 the volunteers decided to close the service
 - 3 the number of items became hard to manage
 - 4 the cost of borrowing books increased

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| 1 For example | 2 By contrast |
| 3 Until then | 4 In this way |

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No.2 / 壊れた物を直すイベント

The Repair Café

Many people throw away broken items such as lamps, clothes, and small machines because they do not know how to fix them. (1), these items often become waste even when only a small part is broken. To change this, a woman in the Netherlands started an event called the Repair Café, where people bring broken things and fix them with the help of skilled volunteers.

At a Repair Café, visitors do not simply hand over their items. Instead, they sit with a volunteer and learn how the repair is done. Because of this, (2). Many people who once felt helpless discover that fixing things is not as difficult as they had thought.

The idea has spread to many countries, and thousands of Repair Cafés now exist around the world. They help reduce (3) and also bring neighbors together. People who meet at these events often share advice, save money, and protect the environment at the same time.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|-------------|
| (1) | 1 | For example | 2 | In contrast |
| | 3 | As a result | 4 | By chance |

- (2)
- 1 visitors gain useful skills of their own
 - 2 the volunteers do all the work alone
 - 3 the items are sent to a factory
 - 4 the café charges a high fee

- (3)
- 1 the number of volunteers
 - 2 the speed of repairs
 - 3 the price of new tools
 - 4 the amount of waste

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No.3 / ベルクロの誕生

A Walk That Led to an Invention

In 1941, a Swiss engineer named George de Mestral went for a walk in the mountains with his dog. When he returned home, he noticed that many small plant seeds, called burrs, (1). Most people would simply remove them and forget about it, but de Mestral became curious about why the burrs stuck so strongly.

He examined the burrs under a microscope and found that they were covered with tiny hooks. These hooks caught easily on the small loops in cloth and fur. de Mestral realized that (2). He then spent years trying to copy this natural design using fabric.

Finally, he created a product made of two strips: one covered with hooks and one with loops. When pressed together, they held firmly, but they could be pulled apart easily. (3), the fastener known as Velcro was born. Today it is used on shoes, bags, and even spacesuits.

- (1)
- 1 had fallen to the ground
 - 2 were stuck to his clothes and his dog's fur
 - 3 had a pleasant smell
 - 4 were good to eat

- (2)
- 1 the burrs were dangerous
 - 2 his dog needed a bath
 - 3 plants could not grow there
 - 4 this idea could be used to join things together

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|---------------------|
| 1 In this way | 2 On the other hand |
| 3 Until then | 4 By contrast |

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No.4 / 種の図書館

A Library for Seeds

In a small town, a group of gardeners noticed that many people wanted to grow their own vegetables but could not afford to buy seeds every year. To help with (1), they created a "seed library" inside the public library. Instead of books, this library lends packets of seeds to anyone who wants them.

The system is simple. Members borrow a few seed packets, plant them, and grow vegetables at home. At the end of the season, (2). These new seeds are then shared with other members the following year, so the library never runs out.

The seed library has become very popular. (3), it has encouraged neighbors to share gardening tips and to grow rare vegetables that are hard to find in shops. Some members say the project has made their whole community healthier and more connected.

- (1)
- 1 a lack of fresh books
 - 2 a shortage of gardeners
 - 3 the loss of the library
 - 4 the high cost of seeds

- (2)
- 1 they buy more seeds from a store
 - 2 they collect seeds from their own plants and return some
 - 3 they throw away the old packets
 - 4 they stop using the library

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| 1 However | 2 By contrast |
| 3 In addition | 4 Until then |

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No.5 / ポストイットの誕生

A Useful Mistake

In 1968, a scientist named Spencer Silver was trying to make a very strong glue. The glue he created, however, (1): it could stick to surfaces but was easy to peel off without leaving a mark. At first, no one knew what to do with such a product.

Years later, another worker at the same company, Art Fry, sang in a church choir. He used small pieces of paper to mark the pages of his songbook, but they kept falling out. Then he remembered Silver's glue and realized that (2). He put a little of the glue on his paper markers, and they stayed in place without damaging the pages.

The company began selling these sticky notes, and they quickly became popular in offices and homes. (3), a glue once thought to be a failure became one of the most useful products in the world. Sometimes a mistake can lead to a great success.

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|-----|---|------------------------|---|------------------------|
| (1) | 1 | turned out to be weak | 2 | was extremely powerful |
| | 3 | disappeared completely | 4 | became very expensive |

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| (2) | 1 | it had become dangerous |
| | 2 | the choir needed more singers |
| | 3 | it was perfect for making bookmarks that could be removed |
| | 4 | he should buy a new songbook |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|-------------|
| (3) | 1 | However | 2 | In this way |
| | 3 | By contrast | 4 | Until then |

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No.6 / サイズが変わる靴

Shoes That Grow with Children

While working in Kenya, an American named Kenton Lee noticed that many children wore shoes that were far too small for their feet. Their families could not afford to buy new shoes as the children grew. Because of this, the children (1). Lee began to wonder whether there was a way to help.

He came up with the idea of a shoe that could change its size. The shoe uses simple buckles and snaps so that (2). One pair can fit a child for several years, growing larger as the child's feet grow, so families do not need to buy new shoes so often.

Lee's company now sends these shoes to children in many poor areas around the world. The shoes are strong, comfortable, and easy to clean. (3), they can be worn for years in difficult conditions, helping thousands of children stay healthy and go to school without pain.

- (1)
- 1 had plenty of shoes
 - 2 often suffered from injuries and infections
 - 3 walked to school happily
 - 4 grew very quickly

- (2)
- 1 it must be sent back to the factory
 - 2 it can only be worn once
 - 3 it changes color in the sun
 - 4 it can be made larger or smaller

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 Therefore | 2 However |
| 3 For example | 4 Until then |

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No.7 / ホタルを取り戻す町

Bringing Back the Fireflies

Long ago, the river that ran through the town of Mizuno was full of fireflies every summer. Over time, however, the water became dirty, and the fireflies disappeared. Worried about (1), a group of local residents decided to take action. They wanted their children to enjoy the same beautiful summer nights that they once had.

The residents began by cleaning the river. They removed trash, stopped factories from releasing dirty water, and planted trees along the banks. (2), they raised young fireflies and released them into the clean water. It took several years of hard work before the insects returned on their own.

Today, thousands of fireflies light up the river each summer, and visitors come from far away to see them. The project did more than save the insects; (3). It taught the whole town how human actions affect nature, and it brought the community together around a shared goal.

- (1)
- 1 the cost of electricity
 - 2 a shortage of water
 - 3 the loss of the fireflies
 - 4 the lack of tourists

- (2)
- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 In addition | 2 However |
| 3 By contrast | 4 Until then |

- (3)
- 1 it caused many arguments among neighbors
 - 2 it changed how people think about the environment
 - 3 it made the river dirty again
 - 4 it forced all the factories to close

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No.8 / アイスキャンディーの偶然

A Frozen Treat by Accident

One cold night in 1905, an eleven-year-old American boy named Frank Epperson made a fruit drink by mixing powder with water. He stirred it with a wooden stick and then (1). The temperature dropped below freezing that night, and the drink turned into ice around the stick.

The next morning, Frank found the frozen drink. Instead of throwing it away, he pulled it out by the stick and tasted it. He was surprised to find that (2). The frozen treat was easy to hold and fun to eat because of the wooden handle.

Years later, as an adult, Frank decided to sell his frozen treat and gave it the name "Popsicle." (3), one of the world's most popular summer snacks was created by accident on a freezing winter night. Today, millions of Popsicles are sold every year.

- (1)
- 1 drank it all quickly
 - 2 poured it down the sink
 - 3 gave it to his sister
 - 4 left it outside and forgot about it

- (2)
- 1 it had become dangerous
 - 2 it was delicious and easy to eat
 - 3 the stick had disappeared
 - 4 the drink had spoiled

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| 1 However | 2 By contrast |
| 3 In this way | 4 Until then |

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No.9 / 時間で支払う仕組み

Paying with Time

In many communities, some people have free time and useful skills, while others need help with daily tasks. To connect (1), a few towns have started something called a "time bank." In a time bank, people do not pay each other with money. Instead, they pay with time.

The system works simply. If a member spends one hour helping someone—for example, by fixing a sink or teaching a language—that member earns one "time credit." Later, (2). A person who is good at cooking might earn credits by making meals and then use them to get help with gardening.

Time banks are useful because everyone's hour is treated as equal, no matter what skill they offer. (3), people who have little money can still take part and feel valued. The system also helps neighbors get to know one another and builds a stronger community.

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|-----|---|-------------------|---|---------------------|
| (1) | 1 | these two groups | 2 | different countries |
| | 3 | several factories | 4 | local schools |

- | | | |
|-----|---|--|
| (2) | 1 | they must return the credit immediately |
| | 2 | the credit loses all its value |
| | 3 | they can use that credit to receive help from others |
| | 4 | they have to pay extra money |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|------------|---|-----------------|
| (3) | 1 | However | 2 | By contrast |
| | 3 | Until then | 4 | For this reason |

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No.10 / 電気のいらないランプ

A Lamp That Needs No Electricity

In many parts of the world, families have no electricity in their homes. After the sun goes down, they often use lamps that burn oil. These lamps are expensive to fuel and produce smoke that is bad for people's health. To solve (1), two designers invented a lamp that needs no oil and no batteries.

Their lamp is powered by gravity. A bag filled with sand or stones is attached to the lamp by a cord. As the bag slowly falls, (2). When the bag reaches the floor, the user simply lifts it again to make more light. The lamp costs almost nothing to use because it needs no fuel.

The lamp has made a real difference in places without power. (3), children can study after dark, and families can save the money they once spent on oil. Because it is clean and safe, the lamp also protects people's health.

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|-----|---|----------------------|---|-------------------|
| (1) | 1 | a lack of designers | 2 | these problems |
| | 3 | the cost of sunlight | 4 | a shortage of oil |

- | | | |
|-----|---|------------------------------|
| (2) | 1 | the bag becomes heavier |
| | 2 | the room fills with smoke |
| | 3 | the lamp must be thrown away |
| | 4 | the lamp gives off light |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | As a result | 2 | However |
| | 3 | By contrast | 4 | Until then |

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No.11 / 本のシェアボックス

The Little Free Library

In 2009, an American named Todd Bol built a small wooden box that looked like a tiny house and filled it with books. He placed it in his front yard with a sign that read, "Take a book, leave a book." He built it to honor (1), who had once been a teacher and loved reading. Neighbors soon began stopping by to borrow and share books for free.

The idea spread quickly. People in other towns built their own little libraries and placed them in parks, on sidewalks, and outside shops. (2), a worldwide movement was born, and hundreds of thousands of these tiny libraries now stand in many countries. Each one is cared for by a local volunteer.

The little libraries do more than lend books. They also encourage people to (3). Neighbors who once passed each other without speaking now stop to chat about the books they have found, and the boxes have helped build friendlier, more connected communities.

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|-------|---|---------------------------|---|----------------------|
| (1) | 1 | his mother | 2 | the town council |
| | 3 | a local company | 4 | the national library |
| <hr/> | | | | |
| (2) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | As a result | 4 | Until then |
| <hr/> | | | | |
| (3) | 1 | buy many new books | | |
| | 2 | read far less than before | | |
| | 3 | build houses of their own | | |
| | 4 | get to know one another | | |

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No.12 / みんなの冷蔵庫

The Community Fridge

Every day, shops and homes throw away large amounts of food that is still safe to eat. At the same time, some people in the same neighborhood do not have enough to eat. To reduce (1), volunteers in several cities have set up "community fridges" on the street. Anyone can leave extra food in them, and anyone who needs food can take it for free.

The fridges are placed in easy-to-reach spots, such as outside cafés or community centers. Volunteers check them every day to make sure the food is fresh and the fridge is clean. Because the rules are simple, (2). People do not need to fill out forms or prove that they are poor; they simply take what they need.

Community fridges have spread to many countries. (3), they cut down on food waste and help people who are struggling, all at the same time. They also remind neighbors that small, everyday actions can make a real difference to those around them.

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|-----|---|---------------------|---|----------------------|
| (1) | 1 | a shortage of shops | 2 | this waste |
| | 3 | the cost of fridges | 4 | a lack of volunteers |

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| (2) | 1 | the fridges are often left empty |
| | 2 | only volunteers may open them |
| | 3 | the food must be paid for |
| | 4 | anyone can use them without feeling ashamed |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | In this way | 2 | However |
| | 3 | By contrast | 4 | Until then |

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No.13 / 廃線→遊歩道

From Railway to Walking Path

For many years, trains carried goods along a railway that ran through the countryside near Ashton. When the railway was finally closed, the tracks were left unused and began to rust. (1), the local government decided to turn the old railway into something useful: a long path for walking and cycling.

Workers removed the old metal tracks and covered the ground with a smooth surface. Trees and flowers were planted along both sides. Today, (2). Families walk their dogs, children ride bicycles, and runners enjoy the fresh air, all in a place that was once dirty and forgotten.

The project has been so popular that other towns have copied the idea. Old railways in many places are now becoming green paths. These trails give people a safe place to exercise and (3). They also protect nature and remind people of their area's history.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-----------------|---|------------|
| (1) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | For this reason | 4 | Until then |

- (2)
- 1 the path is full of people enjoying nature
 - 2 the trains run faster than before
 - 3 the path is closed to the public
 - 4 the area is more polluted than ever

- (3)
- 1 make the air dirtier
 - 2 bring new life to unused land
 - 3 cost the towns a lot of money
 - 4 keep visitors away

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No.14 / 人を貸す図書館

The Human Library

A normal library lends books, but the Human Library lends people. The idea began in Denmark, where organizers wanted to help people understand others who were different from themselves. At a Human Library event, visitors can "borrow" a person for a short conversation. Each person shares a true story about (1), such as living with an illness or coming from another country.

The goal is to break down the unfair ideas that people sometimes hold about strangers. By listening to a real person's story, (2). Many visitors say that after talking with someone face to face, they no longer judge people so quickly based on how they look.

The Human Library has now spread to more than eighty countries. (3), thousands of people have had honest conversations they would never have had otherwise. The project shows that one of the best ways to understand others is simply to sit down and listen to their stories.

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|-----|---|-------------------|---|----------------|
| (1) | 1 | a famous book | 2 | a foreign city |
| | 3 | the local weather | 4 | their own life |

- | | | |
|-----|---|--|
| (2) | 1 | visitors become more afraid of strangers |
| | 2 | visitors learn to see beyond first impressions |
| | 3 | the books become more popular |
| | 4 | the event ends very quickly |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | As a result | 4 | Until then |

2

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次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.15 / 楽器の貸し出し

Music for Everyone

Learning a musical instrument can be expensive, and many children never get the chance because their families cannot afford to buy one. To solve (1), a group of musicians in one city started a program that lends instruments to children for free. Families simply borrow a violin, a flute, or a guitar and return it when the child is finished.

The program collects used instruments that people no longer need. Volunteers repair them so that they sound and look almost new. (2), instruments that might have been thrown away are given a second life in the hands of young learners. The program now lends hundreds of instruments every year.

The results have been wonderful. Children who join the program (3). Some have discovered a true talent for music, and many say that playing an instrument has made them more confident. The program proves that money should never decide who gets to make music.

- | | | | | |
|-------|---|--|---|------------------------|
| (1) | 1 | this problem | 2 | a lack of teachers |
| | 3 | the loss of music | 4 | a shortage of children |
| <hr/> | | | | |
| (2) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | Until then | 4 | In this way |
| <hr/> | | | | |
| (3) | 1 | must pay a large fee | | |
| | 2 | can learn and enjoy music like anyone else | | |
| | 3 | are not allowed to perform | | |
| | 4 | quickly lose interest | | |

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次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.16 / 自転車を自分で直す工房

The Bike Kitchen

In many cities, bicycles are thrown away when they break, even though they could easily be fixed. To change (1), volunteers opened a workshop called a "bike kitchen." It is not a place that sells food, but a place where people can repair their own bicycles using shared tools and free advice.

At the bike kitchen, people do not just drop off their bikes and wait. Instead, experienced volunteers teach them how to make the repairs themselves. Because of this, (2). Once people learn how to fix a flat tire or adjust the brakes, they can keep their bicycles running for many more years.

Bike kitchens have opened in cities around the world. They keep working bicycles out of the trash, save people money, and help the environment. (3), they bring together people who love cycling and want to share what they know. A broken bike is no longer the end of the road.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------------|---|---------------------|
| (1) | 1 | a lack of bikes | 2 | this habit |
| | 3 | the price of food | 4 | a shortage of tools |

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| (2) | 1 | the volunteers grow tired of helping |
| | 2 | the bikes are sent away to a factory |
| | 3 | visitors gain skills they can use again and again |
| | 4 | the workshop becomes very dirty |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | In addition | 2 | However |
| | 3 | By contrast | 4 | Until then |

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No.17 / 屋上菜園

A Garden on the Roof

At a school in a crowded city, there was no open ground where students could grow plants. (1), the teachers decided to use the flat roof of the school building instead. They filled large boxes with soil and helped the students plant vegetables high above the busy streets below.

The students take care of the garden themselves. They water the plants, pull out weeds, and watch the vegetables grow week by week. By doing this, (2). They learn where food really comes from and discover how much work and patience growing it requires.

The rooftop garden has changed the whole school. Vegetables grown there are used in the school lunches, so students eat food they have raised themselves. The project has also (3). Students feel proud of their work, and the once-empty roof has become a green, lively space that the whole school enjoys.

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>(1) 1 By contrast</p> <p> 3 Therefore</p> | <p> 2 However</p> <p> 4 Until then</p> |
|---|--|

- (2) 1 they lose interest in science
- 2 the plants quickly die
- 3 the roof becomes dangerous
- 4 they gain a real understanding of nature and food

- (3) 1 made the lunches worse
- 2 brought the students closer together
- 3 wasted a lot of space
- 4 stopped the students from studying

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No.18 / 読書のパートナー

Reading Buddies

At one elementary school, many young children were struggling to learn to read. Their teachers were busy and could not give each child enough attention. To help with (1), the school started a program that paired the children with older volunteers from the local community. Each week, a volunteer sits with a child and reads together.

The volunteers, many of whom are retired, enjoy the program as much as the children do. Reading together gives the children the practice they need, and (2). Many older volunteers say that spending time with the children makes them feel happier and more useful in their daily lives.

After a year, the children's reading had improved greatly, and strong friendships had formed between the young and the old. (3), the program helped two very different groups in the same community. It showed that learning can bring people of all ages together.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|------------------------|---|--------------------|
| (1) | 1 | a lack of books | 2 | the cost of school |
| | 3 | a shortage of children | 4 | this difficulty |

- | | | |
|-----|---|--|
| (2) | 1 | it gives the volunteers a sense of purpose too |
| | 2 | it makes the children dislike reading |
| | 3 | it keeps the two groups apart |
| | 4 | it costs the school a lot of money |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | In this way | 4 | Until then |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.19 / 電子レンジの誕生

A Sweet Discovery

In 1945, an American engineer named Percy Spencer was working with a machine that produced a type of energy called microwaves. One day, while he was standing near the machine, he noticed something strange: the chocolate bar in his pocket (1). Most people might have ignored this, but Spencer became curious about what had caused it.

To test his idea, Spencer placed some popcorn kernels near the machine. Soon, they began to pop. He realized that (2). The invisible waves from the machine were heating the food from the inside, and Spencer understood that this energy could be used to cook meals quickly.

Spencer and his company developed his discovery into a new kind of oven. (3), the microwave oven, now found in kitchens all over the world, was born from a melted chocolate bar. It is a perfect example of how curiosity about a small accident can lead to a useful invention.

- (1)
- 1 had melted into a sticky mess
 - 2 had turned into gold
 - 3 had grown much larger
 - 4 had completely disappeared

- (2)
- 1 the popcorn was dangerous to eat
 - 2 the microwaves were cooking the food
 - 3 the machine had stopped working
 - 4 the kitchen needed cleaning

- (3)
- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| 1 However | 2 By contrast |
| 3 Until then | 4 In this way |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.20 / 安全ガラス

Glass That Does Not Break Apart

In 1903, a French scientist named Édouard Bénédictus accidentally knocked a glass flask off a shelf. He expected it to break into many sharp pieces, but to his surprise, (1). The glass had cracked, yet it still held its shape, and he looked closely to find out why.

Bénédictus discovered that the flask had once held a liquid plastic, which had dried and left a thin layer inside. This layer (2). When the glass broke, the plastic film held the broken pieces in place instead of letting them fly apart.

Bénédictus realized that this kind of glass could save lives, especially in car windows. (3), safety glass was developed and is now used in cars and buildings everywhere. Because the pieces hold together when it breaks, it protects people from being cut by sharp, flying glass.

- (1)
- 1 the flask grew larger
 - 2 the pieces stayed together
 - 3 nothing happened at all
 - 4 the flask turned to liquid

- (2)
- 1 had coated the inside of the glass
 - 2 had made the glass heavier
 - 3 had no effect at all
 - 4 had changed the glass's color

- (3)
- | | |
|-------------|---------------|
| 1 However | 2 By contrast |
| 3 Therefore | 4 Until then |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.21 / 粘土が掃除用品から玩具へ

From Cleaner to Toy

In the 1930s, a company in the United States made a soft, claylike product that was used to clean dirty wallpaper. For many years it sold well. (1), as homes began using cleaner kinds of heating, walls no longer got so dirty, and people stopped buying the product. The company was in danger of going out of business.

Then a family member noticed that children in a classroom were using the wallpaper cleaner to make shapes and models. She realized that (2). The soft material was safe, colorful, and easy for small hands to shape, so the company decided to sell it as a children's toy instead of a cleaner.

The product, now called Play-Doh, became one of the most popular toys in the world. Children everywhere use it to build animals, food, and anything they can imagine. By being sold in a new way, a cleaning product that had almost disappeared (3). Sometimes a failing idea simply needs to be used for a different purpose.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|-----------------|
| (1) | 1 | For example | 2 | As a result |
| | 3 | However | 4 | In the same way |

- | | | |
|-----|---|--|
| (2) | 1 | the cleaner was dangerous |
| | 2 | it could become a fun toy for children |
| | 3 | children disliked the material |
| | 4 | the product should be thrown away |

- | | | |
|-----|---|-------------------------------|
| (3) | 1 | became more expensive to make |
| | 2 | lost all of its customers |
| | 3 | was banned in many countries |
| | 4 | found great success as a toy |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.22 / チョコチップクッキー

A Cookie by Chance

In the 1930s, a cook named Ruth Wakefield ran a small inn in the United States. One day, she was baking chocolate cookies but found that she had run out of the special baking chocolate she usually used. Instead of stopping, she broke a bar of ordinary chocolate into small pieces and (1), expecting them to melt and spread through the dough.

When the cookies came out of the oven, however, the chocolate had not melted completely. Instead, (2). The small pieces had kept their shape, creating soft cookies full of little chunks of chocolate, and the guests at the inn loved them.

Word of the delicious new cookies spread quickly. (3), the chocolate chip cookie, now loved around the world, was created by accident in a small kitchen. What began as a baking mistake became one of the most popular treats ever made.

- (1)
- 1 ate them all herself
 - 2 threw the bar away
 - 3 sold them to guests
 - 4 mixed them into the dough

- (2)
- 1 the cookies had burned badly
 - 2 the chocolate had disappeared
 - 3 the cookies were dotted with chocolate chips
 - 4 the dough had turned hard

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 In this way | 2 However |
| 3 By contrast | 4 Until then |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.23 / ポテトチップス

The Angry Cook's Invention

In 1853, a cook named George Crum worked at a restaurant in New York. One evening, a customer kept sending back his fried potatoes, complaining that (1). Annoyed, Crum decided to teach the customer a lesson: he sliced the potatoes as thin as paper, fried them until they were hard, and added lots of salt.

Crum expected the customer to be angry. (2), the customer loved the thin, crispy potatoes and asked for more. Soon, other diners wanted them too, and what Crum had made as a joke had become the restaurant's most popular dish.

These thin, salty potatoes became known as potato chips, and today they are eaten by millions of people all over the world. The story of the potato chip (3). It proves that a great idea can come from an unexpected place—even from a cook who was simply trying to win an argument.

- (1)
- 1 they were too thick and soft
 - 2 they were far too salty
 - 3 they were too expensive
 - 4 they were already cold

- (2)
- | | |
|---------------|-------------------|
| 1 For example | 2 As a result |
| 3 However | 4 In the same way |

- (3)
- 1 explains how potatoes grow
 - 2 shows how accidents can lead to success
 - 3 warns people not to cook
 - 4 describes a famous restaurant

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.24 / プチプチ＝気泡緩衝材

An Idea That Found Its Use

In 1957, two engineers were trying to invent a new kind of textured wallpaper. They sealed air between two sheets of plastic, creating a material covered with small bubbles. However, (1). Very few people wanted bubble-covered walls in their homes, and the product did not sell.

The engineers did not give up on their bubbly material. They tried using it to cover greenhouses, but that idea failed too. (2), they realized that the soft, air-filled plastic could protect objects from damage. The bubbles could absorb shocks, keeping fragile items safe.

Soon, companies began using the material, now called bubble wrap, to wrap delicate products before shipping. Today it protects everything from glasses to computers. The engineers' invention finally (3), not as a wall covering, but as a way to keep things safe. Popping its bubbles also became a small joy for people everywhere.

- (1)
- 1 the wallpaper became famous
 - 2 their wallpaper was not a success
 - 3 the bubbles were dangerous
 - 4 the plastic was too cheap

- (2)
- | | |
|---------------|-----------|
| 1 By contrast | 2 However |
| 3 Until then | 4 Finally |

- (3)
- 1 was thrown away for good
 - 2 returned to being wallpaper
 - 3 became a great success
 - 4 stopped being produced

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.25 / アイスのコーン

A Helpful Neighbor at the Fair

At a large fair in the United States in 1904, an ice cream seller was doing great business on a hot day. (1), he soon ran into a problem: he ran out of the paper dishes he used to serve his ice cream. Without dishes, he could not sell any more, and a long line of customers was waiting.

Luckily, a man selling thin, crispy waffles had a stand right next to him. Seeing the problem, the waffle seller rolled one of his warm waffles into the shape of a cone and (2). The ice cream seller placed a scoop of ice cream on top, and the customers were delighted.

The idea was a huge success. People loved being able to hold their ice cream and eat the container too. From that day on, the warm waffle cone (3). The ice cream cone, born from a simple act of teamwork on a hot summer day, remains one of the most popular ways to enjoy ice cream.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|-----------------|
| (1) | 1 | For example | 2 | As a result |
| | 3 | However | 4 | In the same way |

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------------------------------|
| (2) | 1 | handed it to the ice cream seller |
| | 2 | ate it himself |
| | 3 | threw it on the ground |
| | 4 | sold it as bread |

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| (3) | 1 | disappeared from the fair |
| | 2 | was sold only as a waffle |
| | 3 | caused many complaints |
| | 4 | became a popular new way to serve ice cream |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.26 / 水をきれいにするストロー

A Straw That Cleans Water

In many parts of the world, people have no choice but to drink dirty water, which can make them very sick. To help with (1), engineers invented a special straw that cleans water as a person drinks. When someone sucks dirty water through the straw, tiny filters inside trap harmful germs and dirt.

The straw is light, cheap, and easy to carry. A single one can clean thousands of liters of water before it needs to be replaced. Because it needs no electricity or batteries, (2). People can use it at a dirty river, a lake, or a pond and drink the water safely right away.

The straw has been sent to areas hit by floods and other disasters, where clean water is hard to find. (3), it has helped many people avoid illness and stay alive during difficult times. A simple invention has brought safe drinking water to those who need it most.

- (1)
- 1 a lack of straws
 - 2 the taste of water
 - 3 a shortage of engineers
 - 4 this dangerous situation

- (2)
- 1 it is difficult to carry
 - 2 it can be used almost anywhere
 - 3 it only works at home
 - 4 it must be charged daily

- (3)
- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 As a result | 2 However |
| 3 By contrast | 4 Until then |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.27 / 食べられるスプーン

Spoons You Can Eat

Every year, billions of plastic spoons and forks are used once and then thrown away, creating a huge amount of waste. To reduce (1), an inventor in India created spoons that people can eat after their meal. The spoons are baked from grains such as rice and wheat, and they come in different flavors.

The edible spoons are strong enough to be used with hot or cold food, and after the meal, a person can simply eat the spoon as a snack. (2), if someone chooses not to eat it, the spoon will break down naturally in the soil within a few days, unlike plastic, which lasts for hundreds of years.

The inventor hopes that edible spoons will replace plastic ones in restaurants and homes. If they become common, the amount of plastic thrown away each year (3). His idea shows that even a small everyday object can be redesigned to help protect the planet.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|--------------------|---|----------------------|
| (1) | 1 | this plastic waste | 2 | a lack of grain |
| | 3 | the cost of meals | 4 | a shortage of spoons |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|----------|
| (2) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | Until then | 4 | Moreover |

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------------------------|
| (3) | 1 | would stay exactly the same |
| | 2 | would suddenly increase |
| | 3 | could be greatly reduced |
| | 4 | would have no meaning |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.28 / 葉っぱの皿

Plates Made from Leaves

At outdoor events, people often use plastic or paper plates that are thrown away after a single use. In southern India, however, a company makes plates from a surprising material: (1). The plates are made by pressing together the large, fallen leaves of the areca palm tree, using only heat and water—no chemicals at all.

The leaves used to make the plates would otherwise be left to rot on the ground. The company collects them, cleans them, and shapes them into strong, attractive plates. Because of this, (2). No trees are cut down, and a natural waste material is turned into something useful.

After they are used, the leaf plates break down completely in the soil within weeks, and they can even be fed to animals. (3), these plates create almost no waste at all. They prove that nature itself can sometimes provide the best materials for everyday products.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|----------------|---|---------------|
| (1) | 1 | melted plastic | 2 | fallen leaves |
| | 3 | old newspapers | 4 | colored glass |

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| (2) | 1 | the plates are harmful to health |
| | 2 | the plates cost a great deal |
| | 3 | the plates are very kind to the environment |
| | 4 | the trees are quickly destroyed |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|------------|---|-------------|
| (3) | 1 | However | 2 | By contrast |
| | 3 | Until then | 4 | As a result |

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.29 / プラごみのレンガ

Bricks from Plastic Waste

In Kenya, huge amounts of plastic waste fill the streets and rivers, and at the same time many families cannot afford bricks to build proper homes. A young engineer named Nzambi Matee was deeply troubled by both of these problems. (1), she decided to look for a single solution that could deal with them together. After much testing, she invented a method to turn waste plastic into strong building bricks.

In her factory, workers mix plastic waste with sand and heat it until it becomes a thick paste. The mixture is then pressed into bricks and left to cool. The result is that (2). These bricks are even stronger than ordinary concrete ones, and they cost less to make.

Matee's bricks are now used to build homes, schools, and walkways. Her company removes tons of plastic from the environment every year and provides cheap, strong materials for building. Her invention (3). It cleans up pollution and helps people build safe homes at the same time.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-----------------|---|------------|
| (1) | 1 | By contrast | 2 | However |
| | 3 | For this reason | 4 | Until then |

- (2)
- 1 waste plastic is turned into useful bricks
 - 2 the plastic becomes more harmful
 - 3 the bricks break very easily
 - 4 the factory produces more trash

- (3)
- 1 creates more pollution
 - 2 solves two big problems together
 - 3 wastes a lot of money
 - 4 helps no one at all

2

A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(1)から(3)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

No.30 / キノコの梱包材

Packaging Grown from Mushrooms

When companies ship fragile products, they often use plastic foam to protect them. This foam is useful, but it never breaks down and stays in the environment for a very long time. To replace (1), two inventors created a new kind of packaging that is grown rather than made. It uses mushrooms.

To make the packaging, the inventors mix the root part of mushrooms with farm waste, such as corn husks. Over several days, the mushroom roots grow and (2). The material can be grown into any shape needed to protect a product, and once it has formed, it is dried to stop it from growing further.

After the packaging has been used, it can be placed in a garden, where it breaks down and feeds the soil within weeks. (3), the mushroom packaging protects products without harming the planet. It shows that materials grown from nature can replace harmful plastics in our daily lives.

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---------------------|---|----------------------|
| (1) | 1 | a lack of mushrooms | 2 | the cost of shipping |
| | 3 | a shortage of boxes | 4 | this harmful foam |

- | | | |
|-----|---|------------------------------------|
| (2) | 1 | turn into harmful gas |
| | 2 | bind everything into a solid block |
| | 3 | disappear completely |
| | 4 | make the waste dirtier |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|-------------|---|------------|
| (3) | 1 | In this way | 2 | However |
| | 3 | By contrast | 4 | Until then |

解答一覧 | Answer Key

No.	トピック	(1)	(2)	(3)
1	A Library of Things	2	3	4
2	The Repair Café	3	1	4
3	A Walk That Led to an Invention	2	4	1
4	A Library for Seeds	4	2	3
5	A Useful Mistake	1	3	2
6	Shoes That Grow with Children	2	4	1
7	Bringing Back the Fireflies	3	1	2
8	A Frozen Treat by Accident	4	2	3
9	Paying with Time	1	3	4
10	A Lamp That Needs No Electricity	2	4	1
11	The Little Free Library	1	3	4
12	The Community Fridge	2	4	1
13	From Railway to Walking Path	3	1	2
14	The Human Library	4	2	3
15	Music for Everyone	1	4	2
16	The Bike Kitchen	2	3	1
17	A Garden on the Roof	3	4	2
18	Reading Buddies	4	1	3
19	A Sweet Discovery	1	2	4
20	Glass That Does Not Break Apart	2	1	3
21	From Cleaner to Toy	3	2	4
22	A Cookie by Chance	4	3	1
23	The Angry Cook's Invention	1	3	2
24	An Idea That Found Its Use	2	4	3
25	A Helpful Neighbor at the Fair	3	1	4
26	A Straw That Cleans Water	4	2	1
27	Spoons You Can Eat	1	4	3
28	Plates Made from Leaves	2	3	4
29	Bricks from Plastic Waste	3	1	2
30	Packaging Grown from Mushrooms	4	2	1